

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 013 · DEVELOPING

Isomorphic Labs

AI Drug Discovery · London, UK · Private (DeepMind spin-out; \$600M round, unicorn)

DeepMind spin-out Isomorphic Labs raised \$600M into unicorn territory and named its first President - a British AI deep-tech with a precision-science story, low inbound crowding, and no motorsport footprint, ideal to court early.

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OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

DEVELOPING

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Jaguar TCS
Racing

ACTION HORIZON

12+ WKS

THE CASE

Isomorphic Labs, the DeepMind/Alphabet spin-out applying AI to drug discovery, took its first external capital (\$600M) in 2025, entering unicorn territory, and has begun building out its leadership (appointing Colin Murdoch, who also serves as Google DeepMind's Chief Business Officer, as its first President). The standout attribute is low inbound crowding (~25): almost no one in motorsport has called them, so 1440 could be early by a wide margin. It is a British, precision-science brand whose talent-attraction and credibility goals could be served by a measured, tasteful Formula E association - a long-horizon relationship to build now, before the company scales its brand spend and the crowd arrives.

WHY NOW

This is a relationship-first play, not a deal to force this quarter. The value of acting now is positional: getting in while crowding is near zero and a newly-formed commercial leadership is open to ideas, so that when Isomorphic does turn to brand and talent marketing, 1440 is already the trusted motorsport partner rather than one of fifty inbound pitches.

- SPINOFF UNICORN
- NEVER ENTERED
- FUNDING EVENT
- NEW LEADERSHIP
- DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY JAGUAR TCS RACING

Jaguar TCS Racing - British, premium, technology-and-sustainability-led - is the natural cultural and geographic fit for a London deep-tech brand, and its blue-chip audience suits a science-led company focused on credibility and recruitment over consumer reach.

VALUE TO JAGUAR TCS RACING — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B. This is primarily a science, innovation and talent-brand association rather than an in-car technical integration; the value sits in a shared 'precision and discovery' narrative and a recruiting halo for both organisations. Kept deliberately modest and optional-to-scale, it gives Jaguar a distinctive, prestige-science partner and Isomorphic a tasteful, high-credibility brand stage - with room to deepen only if both sides see value.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Start with a modest Official Partner tier on Jaguar TCS Racing, minimum three years, ~\$2-3M/yr, structured to grow, with emphasis on talent/ employer-brand activation rather than heavy consumer signage.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Colin Murdoch
PRESIDENT, ISOMORPHIC LABS (ALSO CHIEF BUSINESS OFFICER, GOOGLE DEEPMIND) - VERIFIED

Isomorphic's first President and the senior commercial leader most likely to own brand and strategic-partnership decisions; he brings deep DeepMind commercial experience. Co-decision-makers: CEO Demis Hassabis (founder) and Sarah Korman, Chief Business & Legal Officer - approach Murdoch/Korman on the commercial side.

OPENING ANGLE

"Colin, almost no one in motorsport has called Isomorphic yet - which is exactly why now is the time. A tasteful, British, precision-science association with Jaguar is a recruiting and credibility asset. Worth an exploratory 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 13 / 20 Took first external capital (March 2025, \$600M) and appointed a first President (Colin Murdoch) - early in its brand life, low urgency.	CAPACITY 16 / 20 Unicorn-territory and Alphabet-linked; capacity is solid, though sponsorship appetite is unproven.	BRAND FIT 13 / 20 British deep-tech with a precision-science story that suits a British team, but pharma is an unusual motorsport category.	URGENCY 10 / 20 Low - a long-horizon relationship play.	OPS FIT 9 / 20 MODE B: no direct in-car use; primarily a science/innovation and talent brand association.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

OFF-STRATEGY RISK A drug-discovery lab may see motorsport as irrelevant to its mission. **Counter:** Frame strictly as talent attraction and a precision-science narrative, kept small and optional-to-scale - not consumer marketing.

UNPROVEN SPONSORSHIP APPETITE The company has never done anything like this. **Counter:** Lead with a low-commitment, high-credibility structure and let the relationship, not a hard sell, carry it.

SOURCES

- <https://www.isomorphiclabs.com/articles/isomorphic-labs-announces-first-phase-of-management-team>
- <https://techcrunch.com/2025/09/08/more-than-10-european-startups-became-unicorns-this-year/>